

Sprint 1 Retrospective

Field	Details
Date	November 7, 2025
Team	LeaveItToUs Development Team
Participants	@Deepthi, @DM, @HB, @SR, @CG

Background

Sprint 1 focused on building the foundational modules of the **Employee Leave Management System (ELMS)** under the *LeaveItToUs* project.

This sprint included development and integration of authentication mechanisms and the core leave application process.

The team worked to ensure that all essential backend services, frontend interfaces, and basic workflow connections were operational by the sprint end.

Sprint Duration: October 25 – November 6, 2025

Sprint Goal: Deliver a minimum viable version of the authentication and leave request features.

Deliverables:

- ELMS-1: User Access & Authentication
- ELMS-5: Leave Application & Approval Workflow

Sprint Outcome:

- Both epics were completed as planned, with integration testing partially done.
 - Minor UI adjustments were postponed to Sprint 2 for refinement.
 - The sprint timeline was slightly extended due to unforeseen integration issues and task dependencies.
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Retrospective Discussion

The team reviewed key highlights and areas for improvement from Sprint 1. Below are the consolidated notes:

What Went Well

- Completed user authentication and leave application modules within time.
- Effective communication across dev and testing teams.
- Clear task allocation and story tracking in Jira.

What Didn’t Go Well

- Daily standups were inconsistent, causing occasional misalignment in priorities.
- The sprint timeline was slightly extended due to unforeseen integration issues and task dependencies.
- Overestimation of capacity; testing got compressed toward the end.

Ideas for Improvement

- Conduct mid-sprint checkpoints to adjust scope.
- Reinforce regular standup schedule to improve coordination.

Start / Stop / Keep Doing Table

Start Doing	Stop Doing	Keep Doing	
Adding daily progress updates in Jira for better visibility	Starting development tasks before sprint planning is finalized	Maintaining clear sprint goals and definitions of done	
Conducting short mid-sprint check-ins to track blockers	Overcommitting story points without considering testing time	Collaborating effectively across dev and QA teams	
Writing unit tests alongside feature development	Ignoring small bugs to “fix later” — causes accumulation	Maintaining documentation after each completed story	

Action Items

1. **Reinforce daily standups** — ensure attendance is consistent and keep them time-boxed to 10–15 minutes.

2. **Conduct mid-sprint reviews** — add a checkpoint to reassess priorities and manage dependencies early.
 3. **Improve estimation accuracy** — involve both development and QA teams when estimating story points.
 4. **Set clear sprint buffers** — reserve 10–15% of sprint capacity for integration/testing overhead.
 5. **Introduce a shared sprint summary document** — record sprint outcomes, blockers, and learnings for transparency.
 6. **Implement a code review checklist** — standardize code review quality and reduce rework.
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Team Feedback Summary

Overall team morale was positive, and the sprint goals were met. The team demonstrated strong ownership and adaptability. The main area needing improvement is consistent participation in standups and communication syncs. The slight extension of the sprint timeline provided a valuable lesson on handling dependencies early and adjusting workloads more realistically. The primary focus for the next sprint will be refining existing workflows and expanding functionality into HR and reporting modules (ELMS-7 and ELMS-8).

Next Sprint Preview:

- **Sprint 2 (Nov 7–Nov 16, 2025)** will focus on:
 - ELMS-7: Leave Policy & HR Management
 - ELMS-8: Notifications, Reports & Error Handling
 - Completing pending UI refinements from Sprint 1
 - Implementing system-wide error handling improvements.